

Problem #5: Pashto

Solution:

If you group the sentences according to tense and aspect (“have broken” is *perfect* aspect, whereas “is breaking” is *imperfect* or continuous), you would observe the following patterns:

- The verb form depends on tense and aspect.
- In the imperfective aspect, there is only one verb – the main verb.
 - In the *present imperfective*, the verb agrees with the subject.
 - In the *past imperfective*, the verb agrees with the object.
- *Window* and *door* belongs to two different noun classes (similar to Hindi – where window or *khirki* is feminine and door or *darwaazaa* is masculine), so they agree with different verb forms.
- In the *present perfective*, there is a main verb (e.g., *broken*) and an auxiliary verb (e.g., *has*).
 - the main verb agrees with the object
 - the auxiliary agrees with the subject.

The verb forms for “break” are as follows:

Aspect	Subject		Object = door		Object = window	
	You (2 nd person)	Sangin (3 rd person)	Singular	Plural	Singular	Plural
Present Imperfect	maatawey	maatawi	--	--	--	--
Past Imperfect	--	--	NA	maatawel	NA	maataweli
Present Perfective	--	--	maat	NA	maata	maati
Auxiliary	key	ki	--	--	--	--

NA: Data not available to infer these forms.

Assignment	Pashto Translations
1) You have broken the door.	Taaso war maat key
2) You have broken the doors.	Cannot be translated because the verb form cannot be inferred from the data.
3) Sangin has broken the windows.	Sangin kerkeyi maati ki
4) Sangin is breaking the doors.	Sangin waruna maatawi
5) You are breaking the door.	Taaso war maatawey
6) Sangin was breaking the door.	Cannot be translated because the verb form cannot be inferred from the data.
7) You were breaking the windows.	Taaso kerkeyi maataweli